
Breaking the Cycle

Not passing on to your children what you received

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

Not passing on to your children what you received

You may have inherited patterns you don't want to pass on in turn: reactions, fears, a way of loving or punishing. Good news: becoming aware of a pattern is already starting to be able to interrupt it.

This guide helps you become 'the one who changes the chain', without guilt or perfectionism.

YOUR INTENTION

An inherited pattern you do NOT want to pass to your children: _____

The 'cycle breaker'

Patterns transmit mainly through example and relationship: becoming aware of them lets you respond differently than 'on autopilot'. This is what's called being a 'cycle breaker' — and it's within reach of anyone who decides to work on it.

Awareness turns an endured reaction into a possible choice.

Example

Sami repeated his father's outbursts unwillingly; recognizing them let him start reacting differently.

My autopilot

Which inherited autopilot would you like to replace with a choice?

Aware = choice

Write: 'What I make conscious, I can choose.'

Takeaway — Becoming aware of a pattern is already being able to interrupt it.

'I'll inevitably repeat it'

'I'm becoming like my parent', 'I won't manage', 'it's stronger than me': these thoughts discourage you before you even try.

Reframe them: repeating isn't a fate, especially with awareness and help.

Example

'I'll be the same parent we had' terrified Léa, until she saw her vigilance already changed everything.

Spot the discouragement

Note a thought saying you'll inevitably repeat · a fairer version.

Not forced

Write: 'With awareness, I'm not doomed to repeat.'

Takeaway — Repeating isn't a fate — awareness opens another path.

You can be the one who changes

You have the right to do differently from what you knew, even if it's uncomfortable and imperfect. Being a cycle breaker isn't being a perfect parent: it's repairing, adjusting, and trying again.

Each pattern you interrupt is a gift for the next generation.

Example

By allowing herself to do differently, without aiming for perfection, Nia gave her child a childhood different from her own.

My gift

What do you want to give your children that you didn't receive?

Repair, not perfect

Write: 'I can repair and try again, without being perfect.'

Takeaway — You can be the link who changes the chain — imperfectly, but truly.

Awareness, repair, new gestures

In practice: spot the triggering pattern, prepare a different response (a gesture, a sentence), and learn to repair after a mistake ('I lost my temper, I'm sorry') — repair counts as much as perfection. Support (therapy, parenting help) strengthens these new gestures.

It's not mistakes that transmit most, but the absence of repair.

Example

By preparing an alternative response to his tense moments, Karim replaced an autopilot with a new gesture.

My new gesture

A triggering autopilot + the different response you prepare: _____

Repair

Write: 'Repair counts as much as perfection.'

Takeaway — Awareness + prepared response + repair: you install new gestures.

Key takeaways

- Becoming aware of a pattern is already being able to interrupt it.
- Repeating isn't a fate: awareness opens a path.
- Being a cycle breaker isn't being perfect.
- Each interrupted pattern is a gift for what follows.
- Prepare a different response to the triggering pattern.
- Repair after a mistake counts as much as perfection.

Your turn

My pattern

The autopilot to replace	The 'I'll repeat' thought

My change

What I want to give	My new gesture

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Understand the cycle-breaker role.

Week 2

Reframe 'I'll inevitably repeat'.

Week 3

Allow myself to do differently, imperfectly.

Week 4

Prepare a new gesture and learn to repair.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'I can repair and try again' line:

What I want to give my children:

My prepared new gesture:

You can be the one through whom change arrives — one gesture at a time.

This guide is a psychoeducation tool, not therapy or a diagnosis. It distinguishes what is established (the relational transmission of trauma) from what is still being researched (biological and epigenetic mechanisms in humans). If you carry trauma, professional support (a psychologist or psychotherapist) is a precious help. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.